



Deserts

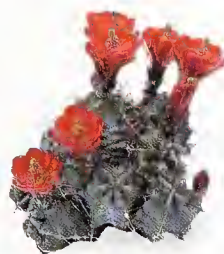


Desert plants

Kokerboom trees can survive for several years without water.



Barrel cacti store water inside their thick, waxy spines and stems.



Hedgehog cacti grow in rocky deserts and flower when it rains.



Century plants bloom once every 20 to 50 years.

Whisker cactus flowers open at night because most insects feed when it's cool.



Deserts are the driest places on Earth. Instead of soil, the land is covered with bare rock, gravel, or sand, so very few plants can grow.



Rocky desert

Hot days, freezing nights, and strong winds make desert rocks splinter and crack.

Sandy desert

Strong desert winds blow sand into ever-changing hills called sand dunes.

Sand dunes can be as tall as a 60-story skyscraper.



An oasis is a place where water flows out of the ground.

Palms and other plants can grow here.

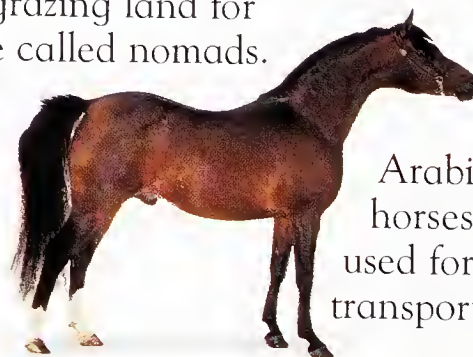
Desert life

People who live in the desert move around, looking for water and grazing land for their animals. They are called nomads.

Bedouin nomads



Saluki dogs are used for hunting.



Arabian horses are used for transportation.

Many nomads use cloth tents to shelter from the burning sun.

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